

RUI SILVA

Senior Creative Operations Leader | Ex-SVP, FARFETCH

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Based in Portugal | Open to remote (EU/global) | EU work authorization

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Senior Creative Operations leader with 15 years scaling the creative engine of one of the world's largest luxury fashion platforms. Rose from Production Manager to SVP at FARFETCH, leading a 600+ FTE global organization (900+ with seasonal staff) across 5 countries with a €40M+ P&L. Delivered a 10% → 1% reduction in operational spend through Lean/Kaizen, AI/ML automation, and Virtual Model technology without dropping luxury quality standards. Trained originally in textile and graphic design, which is why I understand the craft side as well as the operational side.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 10% → 1%** — operational spend as % of sales, without dropping quality
- €40M+ P&L** — annual operational spend across 5-country organization
- 600+ FTE** — 900+ with seasonal staff, across Portugal, UK, US, Hong Kong
- 3.6M+ assets/yr** — 800k SKUs, 4–5 day SLA from arrival to live
- €60 → <€30** — cost-per-item via Virtual Model technology
- 80%+ automation** — product categorization; ML translation in 12+ languages
- 30%+ efficiency** — via Kaizen; 1st place, Kaizen Institute & APGEI award

CORE COMPETENCIES

Strategic Leadership — Global org design (600–900 HC), P&L (€40M+), corporate strategy, cross-cultural teams (PT/UK/US/HK)

Operational Excellence — Kaizen/Lean, process engineering, RPA, TD-ABC

Creative Content at Scale — DAM (3.6M+ assets/yr), content supply chain, luxury QA

Technology Transformation — AI/ML content automation, product categorization, machine translation, Virtual Model, RPA

Craft & Design — Graphic, Product Design and Furniture Prototyping; artisanal quality at industrial-scale profitability

Keywords: DAM, Content Supply Chain, Photo Studio Operations, Virtual Model, RPA, Kaizen, Lean, Process Engineering, AI/ML Automation, ML Translation, Product Categorization, Cross-cultural Leadership, P&L Management, Org Design, SLA Management, Luxury QA

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

FARFETCH | 2009 – February 2024

Production Manager → SVP Creative Operations (15 years, 6 promotions)

SVP Creative Operations | Feb 2022 – Feb 2024

VP Creative Operations | Aug 2018 – Feb 2022

Owned the end-to-end creative content supply chain, from product arrival to on-platform "live": photography, retouching, styling, copy, translation, categorization, catalogue management, and digital asset production across 5 countries. Led through 4 pillars: Content Development, Content Creation, PPM (Planning, Performance & Management), and SDD (Services Design & Development).

- ▶ Drove a 10% → 1% reduction in operational spend as a percentage of sales, managing a €40M+ annual budget without dropping quality standards.
- Led 600+ FTE team (900+ with seasonal staff) across PT/UK/US/HK; 6–7 direct reports
- Built Portugal and Hong Kong studios from scratch; developed and promoted internal talent
- Delivered 3.6M+ digital assets/yr, 800k SKUs, 4–5 day SLA
- Virtual Model technology: cut cost-per-item from €60 to <€30
- 80%+ automation of product categorization; ML translation across 12+ languages

Senior Director, Creative Operations | Jan 2017 – Jul 2018

Guimarães / London / Los Angeles / Hong Kong

- Expanded creative operations into LA and Hong Kong, building 2 local teams and studios from scratch
- Aligned production standards across 4 cultural markets with shared workflows and quality gates

Earlier roles at FARFETCH (2009 – 2016)

Production Manager → Production Director → Global Production Director

Built the production engine from the shop floor. These were the years where the operational culture and quality standards that later scaled to 5 countries were formed. Led production across 4 countries reporting to the COO before stepping into the Senior Director role.

RUI SILVA STUDIO | Founder & Creative Director | May 2024 – Present

A contemporary collectible furniture practice: one-of-a-kind pieces in oak, steel, brass, and porcelain. A labor of love kept running when time allows.

- Designed and launched the Lusitano Collection, handcrafted furniture inspired by Portugal's Lusitano horse
- Own the full lifecycle: concept, design, sourcing, manufacturing, finishing, brand, website

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Product Owner (CSPO) — Scrum Alliance

CAP — Certificate of Professional Trainer — AEP

Photojournalism — GI Press Office of Guimarães

Multimedia & Web Design — School of Technology / IPFEL

Methods training: Lean Thinking, VSM, SMED, 8D, TD-ABC

LANGUAGES

Portuguese (native)

English (professional)